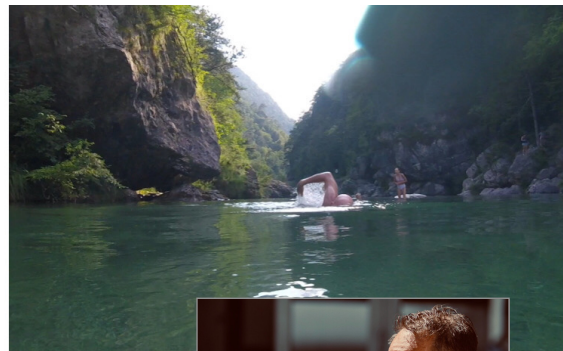
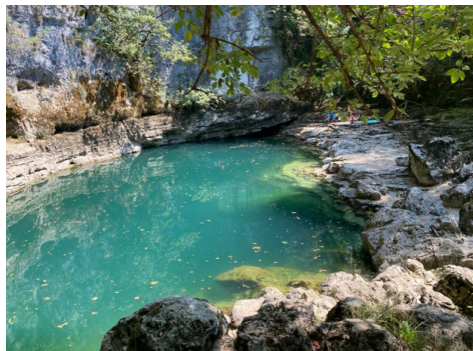


Architect Claudio Calderoni has moved to Sweden many years ago.
In this country he has learned a very common and particular practice...

The Evidence of Body

As the most up-to-date cognitive psychology teaches us, our body's surroundings are more akin to an extension of ourselves than a neutral background in which we move.



Perhaps because on the borders of plains, mountains and river shores, Bassano definitely has the 'gift of liminality'. Like few other places, it invites those rites of passage that make ambiguity and disorientation a virtue. Those who now with a half-smile might be thinking of the erratic disorientation of a 'goto' of grappa, however, would be baffled to observe how much this tradition coincides with the use of psychoactive substances typical of much more ancient and noble shamanic rites.

Either way, in these lands we have always known how to celebrate the return to the body and the immersion in nature with unique mastery. Not just any nature, but precisely that which most belongs to a body, the local one.

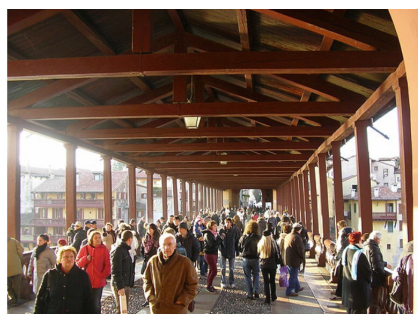
I am not only referring to the renaissance of "the Bassanos", famous painters' family workhouse, with their unique iconography of bodies immersed in a farm-to-table nature, but also to the bridge-loggia with which Palladio in an incomparable manner invites our bodies to immerse themselves in the nature of their river, making it a ritual. I speak of return because the cyclical tendency to forget the value of the immersion in nature is part and parcel of the universal process of

urbanisation occurred with the introduction of agriculture. Back then, no more than a handful of millennia ago, we tasted the sweet and sinful apple of settledness, abandoning forever a history of hunting and gathering that had lasted millions of years. From that pivotal step onwards, from time to time we need a refreshment to bring us back in tune with our original habitat. May be because I live in Sweden, fact is that years ago I took this need to the letter and discovered that my neighbours' dipping into the frozen lake before our houses in their summer outfits was more than just a healthy practice. The most important thing we get rid of are unnecessary insecurities.

Never would I have imagined, however, that doing so in Bassano, my hometown, could turn a dip in the Brenta river into a plunge in a past that was not only rich in culture but also full of wonders that I was unaware of, such as the little

Subiolo lake, the Calieroni di Valstagna and the many other shores. This exposure to the cold has become the beginning of an exploration of the body that goes hand in hand with the exploration of half-unknown spots in places where I feel at home. As Palladio sensed, it goes both ways: to feel at home in an unfamiliar place, the first thing to do is to dive into its nature. This, as the most up-to-date cognitive psychology teaches us, is because our body's surroundings are more akin to an extension of ourselves than a neutral background in which we move.

In my first Swedish winters, I noted with disappointment the nonchalant dressing of the locals in the face of my creeping shiver despite the very technical polar mission outfit – a form of technological burka. The suffocating comfort we choose as our surroundings, atrophies the body, necrotizes the habitat and unexpectedly makes us even more insecure.



FOCUS

By Claudio Calderoni
Our Stockholm correspondent

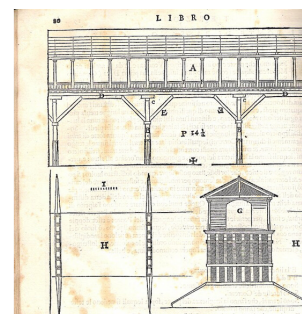
*L'acqua è la forza che ti tempera,
nell'acqua ti ritrovi e ti rinnovi.*
Eugenio Montale *



Claudio Calderoni, architect and for years collaborator with the Los-Pulitzer studio, originally from Bassano, lives in Stockholm where in 2020 he founded *Icebrreakers*, a company that organizes workshops to expand the comfort zone through environmental awareness seminars and cold water immersions.

Top, from left, under the title Natural wonders of our region: Little Subiolo Lake, Valstagna; Contrà Pria, Arsiero; Pozze Smeraldine, Tramonti di Sopra, Pordenone.

Bottom, from the left Grappa aperitive and walk rituals on the Palladian bridge; Andrea Palladio drawings from his "Quattro Libri" architecture treatise published in 1570.





Top left, The Parable of the Sower, oil on canvas, 1550, Jacopo Bassano, Museum Thyssen-Bornemisza, Madrid: in the background the Grappa chain and the Brenta river with its typical vegetation; the quantity and size of the animals is combined with accidental human figures seen from behind without regard to pedicure; the protagonist is almost unnoticeable, being portrayed in a reduced size and off-centre, with colours and luminosity that confuse his figure with the background. Everything contributes to conveying an anthropomorphic rather than anthropocentric vision of the world.

Top right, Hornsberg Beach on Lake Mälare in Stockholm, Sweden: local youth engaged in winter swimming.



Center, Pozze Smeraldine, Tramonti di Sopra, Pordenone.

Bottom: Vecchia Strada del Cellina between Barcis and Ravedis Lakes, Pordenone: when the exploration of the local nature accompanies a deep exploration of the body, it becomes an immersion in an extended body, capable of expanding the comfort zone and enabling our dormant potential.



* Water is the force that tempers you,
in water you find yourself and renew
yourself.

Eugenio Montale